

Risk Questionnaire

Hypertension — risk-assessment questionnaire

A short self-screening for adults who want to estimate their personal hypertension risk and the urgency of seeing a health worker. Derived from the WHO *HEARTS technical package* risk factor framework, the *Be He@lthy Be Mobile — mHypertension* example evaluation questions (Annex 5), and the *WHO global brief on hypertension*.

This is a triage tool, not a diagnosis. A blood pressure measurement by a health worker is the only way to confirm hypertension.

Section 1 — Have you been screened recently?

Q1. When was the last time you had your blood pressure measured by a health worker or a working machine?

- (0) Within the last 12 months
- (1) Between 1 and 3 years ago
- (2) More than 3 years ago, or never

Q2. Do you know your most recent blood pressure reading?

- (0) Yes, it was below 140/90
 - (1) Yes, it was between 140/90 and 160/100
 - (2) Yes, it was above 160/100
 - (1) No, I don't remember the numbers
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Section 2 — Personal risk factors

Q3. What is your age?

- (0) Under 35
- (1) 35-54
- (2) 55 or older

Q4. Do you have a parent, brother or sister who was diagnosed with high blood pressure, heart attack, stroke or heart failure before age 60?

- (0) No
- (2) Yes
- (1) Don't know

Q5. Are you overweight (a noticeable extra weight around the waist)?

- (0) No
- (1) A little
- (2) Yes, significantly

Q6. Have you ever been told you have diabetes or high blood sugar?

- (0) No
- (2) Yes

Q7. Have you ever been told you have high cholesterol or “high fat in the blood”?

- (0) No
 - (1) Yes
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Section 3 — Lifestyle

Q8. How often do you cook with stock cubes (Maggi, bouillon) or eat salty/processed foods (instant noodles, salty fish, processed meat)?

- (0) Rarely or never
- (1) A few times a week
- (2) Daily

Q9. How many portions of fruit and vegetables do you eat on a typical day? (1 portion = 1 fruit, or 3 tablespoons of cooked vegetables)

- (0) 5 or more
- (1) 2-4
- (2) Less than 2

Q10. How many minutes per week of physical activity do you do that makes you breathe faster (brisk walking, gardening, dancing, sport)?

- (0) 150 or more
- (1) 50-149
- (2) Less than 50

Q11. Do you smoke or use tobacco?

- (0) No, never have
- (1) Used to, but quit
- (2) Yes, currently

Q12. How often do you drink alcohol?

- (0) Never
- (0) Less than once a week
- (1) 1-3 days per week
- (2) 4 or more days per week, **or** more than 2 drinks on a typical drinking day

Q13. Are you living with significant stress most days (sleep problems, ongoing worries, feeling overwhelmed)?

- (0) No
 - (1) Sometimes
 - (1) Yes, most days
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Section 4 — Symptoms (do not ignore)

Answer “yes” or “no” to each. **Even one “yes” should be discussed with a health worker, regardless of total score.**

Q14. Do you sometimes have headaches that are unusually severe? **Q15.** Do you ever feel sudden dizziness, especially when standing? **Q16.** Do you get short of breath doing things that didn’t used to make you

breathless? **Q17.** Have you noticed your heart racing or pounding without a clear reason? **Q18.** Do you ever have chest pain or pressure on exertion? **Q19.** Have you had any sudden visual changes, weakness on one side of your body, or trouble speaking — even briefly? *(These can be warning signs of stroke and should be checked urgently.)*

Scoring (Sections 1-3)

Add up the numbers in parentheses for Q1-Q13. Maximum possible: about 26.

Total	Interpretation
0-5	Low risk profile. Your habits and screening are in good shape. Have your blood pressure checked at least once a year and keep the routines you have.
6-12	Moderate risk profile. Some risk factors are above ideal. Have your blood pressure measured within the next 1-3 months. Pick one or two of the lifestyle areas (salt, vegetables, activity, tobacco, alcohol) to work on first.
13-19	High risk profile. Several risk factors point to elevated cardiovascular risk. Have your blood pressure measured within the next few weeks. If you have not seen a health worker in over a year, book an appointment. Address the lifestyle areas you scored 2 on, one at a time.
20+	Very high risk profile. Please arrange a clinic visit within the next 1-2 weeks for a blood-pressure check and a broader cardiovascular review. The combination of factors you reported significantly raises your risk of heart attack and stroke — but most of these factors are modifiable, and acting now makes a real difference.

Section 4 (symptoms) overrides the score

- Any single “yes” in Q14-Q18 → see a health worker within the next 1-2 weeks for evaluation, regardless of total score.
- Any “yes” in Q19 (sudden visual loss, one-sided weakness, sudden trouble speaking) → **see a health worker today.** If the symptom is happening right now, treat as a medical emergency and call for help.

What this questionnaire does not do

- It does not diagnose hypertension. Only a blood-pressure measurement can do that.
- It does not estimate the percent chance of having a heart attack in the next 10 years (formal cardiovascular risk scores like SCORE or WHO/ISH charts do that, and require a clinician).
- It does not replace any advice your own health worker has given you.

If your score is moderate or higher, the most useful single next step is to have your blood pressure measured — most clinics and many pharmacies can do this in five minutes.